GUIDED CHALLENGE

The 7-Day AI Learning Challenge

Fifteen minutes a day. One calmer relationship with AI.

No streaks to protect, no expensive tools required, and no prize for becoming an “AI person” by Friday. Just one useful practice at a time.

INSIDE THIS GUIDE

01 A simple setup and weekly tracker
02 Seven 15-minute daily practices
03 Prompts and privacy reminders
04 Space to reflect after each day
05 A realistic plan for what comes next

PLAIN ENGLISH ON PURPOSE

Print it. Write on it.
Make it yours.

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How this week works

This is a learning challenge for people with a life. Fifteen minutes can count. Missing a day can count too. The point is to build a little firsthand experience, not to perform enthusiasm for a technology.

What you need

- One AI assistant you can access. Many offer free tiers; you do not need to pay for this challenge.
- A notes app or paper for saved prompts and observations.
- A timer and roughly fifteen minutes a day.
- A healthy amount of skepticism.
- Under 18? Ask a parent or guardian and use the account or supervision they approve.

Three ground rules

- **Pick one tool for the week.** Switching tools every day turns practice into browsing. You can compare tools later.
- **Keep private data out.** Use invented details for exercises. No government IDs, bank details, medical records, patient information, other people's messages, or confidential work material.
- **Follow the rules where you learn or work.** A school, employer, or professional body may say no to AI use even when the tool says yes. Those rules come first.

The week at a glance

DAY	PRACTICE	DONE
1	Meet the machine	☐
2	Upgrade one prompt	☐
3	Learn something real	☐
4	Make something useful	☐
5	Check before you trust	☐
6	Build a tiny workflow	☐
7	Teach it back	☐

TRY THIS

The only streak that matters

If you miss a day, open the next page and continue. No reset, no confession, no catching up by doing three days at once. The challenge is a container, not a deadline.

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Day 1: Meet the machine

Today's aim: Build a realistic first impression. Learn what this tool does well, where it gets slippery, and how it wants to be talked to. Fifteen minutes, no perfect prompt required.

Your 15 minutes

01 **Minute 1–2: Start clean.** Open a new chat. Take a breath. There is no penalty for asking a basic question.

02 **Minute 3–10: Try three questions.** Ask about something you know well, something that needs a current fact, and something that requires a small plan.

03 **Minute 11–15: Look for the seams.** Notice what was generic, confidently vague, or flat-out wrong. Write down one limitation.

PROMPT RECIPE — START WITH A TOUR

I'm new to AI. Ask me three questions about what I want help with, then give me one small practice task based on my answers. Keep the language plain. Tell me two things you are not reliable for.

WATCH OUT

It is predicting, not knowing

A language model produces likely language based on patterns. It does not automatically look up a fact, know your situation, or understand consequences. A fluent answer is not evidence.

You're done when

- [ ] You have tried three different kinds of question.
- [ ] You can finish this sentence: "This tool is useful for _____, but I need to check _____."
- [ ] You noticed one moment where it was not a reliable authority.

One thing that surprised me:

One limit I noticed:

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Day 2: Upgrade one prompt

Today's aim: Feel the difference between a vague wish and a useful request. This is the single skill that makes everything else in the week easier.

Your 15 minutes

01 **Minute 1–3: Ask a lazy version.** Try "Help me plan my week." Notice what comes back.

02 **Minute 4–10: Add what matters.** Give the goal, real constraints, a format, and one boundary.

03 **Minute 11–15: Compare.** Put the two answers side by side. Write down one specific difference.

PROMPT RECIPE — BEFORE: VAGUE

Help me plan my week.

PROMPT RECIPE — AFTER: USEFUL

Help me plan the next five weekdays around these real tasks: [paste 4–6 tasks]. I have about [hours available] and want to protect time for [priority]. Give me a simple table with day, focus, and a 20-minute minimum version. Don't fill every hour;
leave white space. Ask me one question if the plan depends on
something missing.

You're done when

- ☐ You have a before-and-after pair.
- ☐ You can name the details that changed the answer.
- ☐ You have added one prompt to your notes.

The difference I noticed:

TRY THIS

Specific, not exhaustive

A useful prompt is not a five-page autobiography. It gives the model the details that change the result: the goal, the constraints, the audience, the format, and what not to do.

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Day 3: Learn something real

Today's aim: Use AI as a tutor, not an answer machine. Pick something you have been meaning to understand — a concept, a process, a piece of software, a chapter of a book.

Your 15 minutes

01 **Minute 1–2: Pick a topic and say what you already know.** A small useful topic beats a giant vague one.

02 **Minute 3–10: Learn through questions.** Ask the AI to quiz you and wait for your answers.

03 **Minute 11–15: Explain it back without looking.** Then ask for one correction and one next gap.

Need a topic? Try how a bill becomes law, how compound interest works, what an API is, how local AI runs on a computer, or how to read a nutrition label. Choose something you actually want to know.

PROMPT RECIPE — BE MY PATIENT TUTOR

Be my plain-English tutor for [topic]. I know [your starting point]. Ask me one question at a time and wait for my answer. Start with a concrete example, not a definition. After five questions, ask me to explain the idea back. Then point out one accurate part and one gap. Don't praise me unless there is something specific to praise.

You're done when

- ☐ You have written a three-sentence explanation in your own words.
- ☐ You can name one thing that still feels fuzzy.
- ☐ You have not used AI as a substitute for a teacher, clinician, or required source.

My three-sentence explanation:

Still fuzzy:

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Day 4: Make something useful

Today's aim: Create one modest, real thing you would actually use. Not a demo. Not a masterpiece. A draft that saves you a little time or starts a stuck task.

Your 15 minutes

01 **Minute 1–3: Choose a small real task.** An email you have been avoiding, a packing list, a meal plan, a project outline, a plain-language summary of public information, a story idea, a chore schedule.

02 **Minute 4–10: Make the first draft.** Give the AI your facts, audience, and format.

03 **Minute 11–15: Edit by hand.** Change anything that does not sound like you, check the details, and remove what does not belong.

PROMPT RECIPE — MAKE A USEFUL FIRST DRAFT

Help me create [specific thing] for [audience]. The result needs to [outcome].

Here are the facts: [paste non-sensitive notes].
Use this format: [email / checklist / table / outline].
Keep it [plain, warm, direct]. Avoid [thing you don't want].
After the draft, list three places I should check before using it.

WATCH OUT

Follow the rules of the room

For school or work, use AI only when allowed. If disclosure is required, disclose. Do not let a draft take credit for work, judgment, or facts that are not yours.

You're done when

- [ ] You have a usable draft, not just a chat transcript.
- [ ] You changed at least three things by hand.
- [ ] You checked anything factual that matters.

What I made:

What I changed and why:

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Day 5: Check before you trust

Today's aim: Practice the habit that separates useful assistance from quiet trouble. Check one claim, then do one privacy drill.

Your 15 minutes

01 **Minute 1–4: Pick a claim** from Day 3 or Day 4 — a date, number, rule, quotation, or "fact."

02 **Minute 5–10: Ask how it could be verified.** Then verify at least one claim with a primary or official source. If the tool gives links, open them.

03 **Minute 11–15: Practice redaction.** Rewrite one sentence or task so it contains no identifying details. If you cannot remove the detail safely, do not use AI for that task.

PROMPT RECIPE — SEPARATE FACT FROM FILLER

Fact-check this draft: [paste].

Separate verifiable facts from opinions, ideas, and style. For each fact, say what primary or official source could verify it. Mark anything you cannot support as "needs checking." Do not invent links, statistics, quotations, titles, or dates.

Your privacy drill

Turn real-ish details into placeholders before they go into a prompt.

TOO SPECIFIC	BETTER
A person's name and address	"A family member," "my town"
A bank, card, or account detail	"Card A," "a household bill"
A patient, client, or student detail	Remove it; ask a general question
A confidential project name	"An internal project"

You're done when

- ☐ You verified one claim outside the chat.
- ☐ You found zero invented citations to rely on.
- ☐ You practiced one redaction.
- ☐ You know one question you should ask a human instead.

The claim and what I found:

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Day 6: Build a tiny workflow

Today's aim: Make one recurring task easier without giving up human review. A saved prompt in your notes is a perfectly respectable workflow.

Your 15 minutes

01 **Minute 1–3: Choose a small recurring task.** Weekly meal planning, meeting prep, a first-pass proofread, a study quiz, a project check-in, or turning notes into a clean outline.

02 **Minute 4–10: Write and test a reusable prompt.** Replace one-time details with clearly marked blanks.

03 **Minute 11–15: Add a human check.** Decide what you will always verify before using the output.

PROMPT RECIPE — TURN THIS INTO A REUSABLE PROMPT

Help me turn this recurring task into a reusable prompt: [describe the task]. Ask me up to three questions about the output, constraints, and common mistakes. Then write a fill-in-the-blank prompt I can save. Keep it under 150 words.

My tiny workflow

The task I do repeatedly:

My saved prompt:

My human check:

WATCH OUT

Leave the dangerous parts manual

Do not fully automate decisions involving money, medication, employment, legal matters, housing, other people's data, or anything irreversible. A workflow can prepare information; a human should approve the consequential step.

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Day 7: Teach it back

Today's aim: Turn a week of small experiences into understanding you can keep. Teaching is the test. If you can explain it plainly, you are less likely to be dazzled by it.

Your 15 minutes

01 **Minute 1–5: Explain the basics to someone** — a friend, a family member, or an empty page. What is AI good at? What is it not reliable for? What is one rule you will keep?

02 **Minute 6–10: Make a mini capstone.** Use AI for one small real task in three steps: define it, draft it, verify it. Save the result and your edits.

03 **Minute 11–15: Write your own policy.** Three sentences. Not a corporate manifesto. Just how you want to use this tool.

PROMPT RECIPE — HELP ME TEACH IT BACK

Interview me like a patient teacher. Ask me five questions about what I learned regarding [topic or this week's practice]. Then give me a short report card: one thing I explained well, one gap, and one next thing to learn. Be kind and specific; don't flatter me.

My personal AI rules

1. I will use AI for…

---

2. I will not put…

---

3. I will always check…

You're done when

- ☐ You have explained the basics out loud.
- ☐ You made one small thing and edited it.
- ☐ You wrote three rules you can actually follow.

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After the week

You did not become an AI expert in seven days. Good. Expertise is not the goal. A working sense of what the tool is for, where it fails, and when to stop is far more useful than memorizing features.

A quick look back

My favorite use this week:

The biggest limitation I noticed:

The habit I want to keep:

A fifteen-minute weekly practice

Pick one recurring appointment with yourself. Each week, do one small cycle:

- ☐ Learn one new thing.
- ☐ Make or improve one useful draft.
- ☐ Check one important claim.
- ☐ Save one prompt or lesson in your notes.

That is enough. You do not need to keep up with every release, app, or argument. The useful question is not “What can AI do now?” It is “What is a good use of AI in my actual life this week?”

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Where to go next

- Revisit the challenge with a different real task.
- Read the **Beginner AI Glossary** when a word gets in the way.
- Use the **AI Privacy Checklist** before you connect a new tool or paste something personal.
- Try the **AI Prompt Cheat Sheets** when you want a better first draft.
- If you are curious about running a model on your own device, look for a local-AI guide and check your computer's memory and privacy setup first.

> GOOD TO KNOW
>
> **This is not a certificate**
>
> No credential, guarantee, or professional qualification comes with this page. It is a record of practice. Keep the prompt, the rule, and the small habit that earned its place.

ONE LAST THING · 06

Use one thing. Then keep it.

Set a 15-minute appointment with yourself tomorrow and return to Day 1. You do not need momentum; you need a small, repeatable beginning.

MY NEXT SMALL STEP

THE RULE FOR THIS HALF OF THE PACK

Use AI like a useful first draft — not a final authority. Keep your judgment, check the facts, and protect private information.

More AI printables

01 AI Prompt Cheat Sheets

02 Beginner AI Glossary

03 AI Privacy Checklist

04 AI for Job Search

05 AI for Budgeting

Free to use

Print these for yourself, your classroom, or a client. Please keep the credit and don't resell the files.

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Keep the useful part. Leave the rest.